

Sociology:-

RTI:- Any citizen of free India is free to question the government / governmental bodies about for information

DPDP:- Right to privacy, data privacy / data protection

Govt started using DPDP to reject RTI requests

Hence, Yuganther, an NGO, created a "translation" portal where people can file RTIs anonymously, and if it was of public interest, they rephrase the requests & file the RTI

They file using post, since it is more trustworthy.

But how do you make the government accountable? How does Public Interest & Anonymity go hand in hand.

More anonymity = more people can ask questions about the different levels of the government.

Social Contract prioritising anonymity would result in better governance

Influencers?

Micro influencers = followers = 10k - 100k

Most micro influencers / lifestyle influencers, crypto investors, etc. are predominantly from rural areas / metropolitan areas because of aspirations. Hustlers. Doing this so that they can improve their lifestyle.

Money is a universal equaliser. But requires double co-incidence.

Barter is involved with these influencers:

i) Altruistic Barter:- Production without getting any kickback.

ii) Commodity Barter:- Get good(s) in return for producing reels & views

iii) Monetisation

Every view is subjective

Bengal Famine in 1939, Winston Churchill asked all food from Bengal to be sent to the war.

Inclusivity:- To fit in, to belong
Prestige

Peter Berger:- A sociologist must be a skeptic
They must ask questions to common sense & notions that taken for granted.

Be like a Spy: Report from a value free perspective, an objective perspective.

Do not accept presented narratives. QUESTION THEM!

Sociologists occupy themselves with the unethical & the unacceptable.

The nature of sacredness & profanity should not be considered by sociologists. No question should be left unasked for these reasons.

Debate & relative issues:

Meaning is context dependent, different entities & beliefs in different parts of the world.

MIC :- Military Industrial Conflict → has vested interests in war

Creative Destruction in Capitalism:- Destroy creative products to gain profits by speculating.

Race to the bottom:- Post colonial world fighting with each other for profits

What is sociology:-

Study of societies individuals & groups.

Understanding / theorising society.

Relationship b/w individuals & the larger societies around them.

Role of social structures, institutions & cultures.

Question only that which seems to be "common sense".

One does not question why people do not cross the street when the signal is on green.

Voice Vote

Questions assumptions, to check for scientific grounding for statements & beliefs

Studies social interactions, practices & processes:-

Social Institution:-

Amorphous body that uses "carrot and stick" to make people follow "norms"

Ex:- Caste, Gender, Religion, etc.

~~Demos~~ They demarcate that which is sacred and that which is profane.

Social Structures:-

Stratifies societies vertically and horizontally, imposes a hierarchy upon it.

Ex:- Race

Wage is illy in capitalism, since while wage is a result of capitalism, capitalists would love to not pay wage to their workers. Hence slave labour.

"State is a need that people feel" - Rousseau.

Geopolitical Ordering:- Splitting into Global North & Global South.

Progress brings out certain risks. These risks can affect more than just the marginalised societies - Ulrich Beck (?)

Mobility:- So. Geographic ← for education, work, etc.

Social & Economic ← This requires individual transformations (in commodities / activities etc). [symbols of mobility]

Caste Structure is not mobile. One is ascribed to it upon birth, unlike class which is more opinion.

Sociological Imagination:-

Seeing the general in the particular.

"Social Perspective" - Peter Berger

Locating general patterns in the behaviour of specific individuals.

Helps us understand how personal choice is shaped by ...

Open are the veins of ~~the~~ North Latin America.

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Scientific Revolution:

Rise in the idea of questioning society & power.
Scientific rationality develops only when one questions the normatives.

Inquiry should be done using the Scientific Method

Scientific Method :- Empiricism & Replicability

Colonisation:

↳ Establishment of colonies & setting up the rule of law

Context:- Places where the (British) officers stayed in colonies.

↳ Since Reformation had happened, the rule was under the 'Crown' rather than by Divine Rights.

Indology:- Study of Indian Society to learn how it functioned.
To help with the idea of Restitutive Justice.

↳ People Criminals would be reformed through the penal system.

Study of Indic culture through books & other artifacts.
Results in bias due to stuff like essential practices of religion & ideal religion.

Max Müller was a German who was tasked with indology through the Dharmashastra. But the Dharmashastra was an ideal view.

Louis Duménil ← grs French, gives an idea of what is sacred & what is profane. Studied the caste system.

This book view is then converted into an ideal called the Field view.

Empiricism is constrained by context. What was found in one place need not hold elsewhere.

In such a well connected world, social aspiration is no longer limited to the urban populace.

~~It's always~~ It's always enter to ask questions of the system.

Different Schools

(i) Bombay School :-

~~It is~~ Interested in kinship & family.

(ii) Lucknow School :-

Historicity of how the Indian Society change
Development of

Sources :- IGNOU :- ↑ Sociology in India.

How does one analyse massive social shifts / changes? (in Europe during the Industrial Revolution)

Marx, Le Marx, Weber, & Durkheim approach these ~~these~~ questions with different view points.

Modernisation + Globalisation + (What?) were big changes in India during the late 20th century.

We deal with their methods & approaches, not their conclusions.

(i) Karl Marx & Friedrich Engels :-

Industrial Revolution is the pinnacle of the capitalist age

Feudalism vs Capitalism?

What led to the Rise of Capitalism?

Feudalism :- Not regular contracts - that can be entered & exited freely. One cannot choose one's employer or employees. Zamindari system in India. The zamindar is sort of the patron to their serfs/workers. Workers were attached to the land / zamindari. A form of "noblesse oblige".

To understand the shift to capitalism, Karl Marx studied social strata → group of people having certain similarities in features.

They claim the existence of class based social stratification. Middle-class ← social strata based on income or capital.

- 1) Stratification is not natural - doesn't just happen. It is a result of specific historical (economic, social, political) processes.
- 2) Stratification is not essential - it is conflict ridden and thus has the inherent potential to change shape.

These contradictions / conflicts can only be held in check, at some point it will blow up & social change will ensue.

The contradictions push for social change.

Human existence is heavily dependent on handling these conflicts.

The Marxist Approach:-

Marx & Engels were materialists (material is more important than idea / mind). Ideas follow material reality. Ideas of liberty, equality, & fraternity are a result of the contradictions in society. It was the material & social relations that caused that.

How does any society produce the immediate essentials?

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Structural Functionalism looks at society like a biological system, esp the human body. Each structure in society is meant to perform certain actions.

This question helps analyse the society itself.

Using the study of production, consumption, and distribution to study society is to be a materialist.

What is to be produced, and what is needed to produce it?

In hunting gathering societies, it was mainly subsistence. No settled production. No "cultivation" for long periods of time.

The idea of private property is a given in our modern society.

Settled agriculture provided surplus food. This led to Feudalism. Raises the question of What is To Be Done with the surplus, its distribution. This resulted in the first cases of private property, and the first class based societies.

Similarly, the emergence of new raw materials, labour, markets, industries that resulted in the formation of Capitalist societies. Industrial revolution had very fast migration to industrial cities (within 25-30 years).

Contradiction with the feudal order - bonded labourers ought to be free to choose their employers for industries to function.

Law in capitalist society protects the right to own private property.

Both the superstructure & the base can maintain & shape each other. Forest Protection Act - 2006 allows tribals to claim "patla" on forest lands.

The laws of monogamy are also a direct result of having to pass down property. Led to the rise of patriarchal society.

Alienation is a feature of this approach capitalist society.

Humans are not associated with the product of their own labour.

It is an alienation from self & nature as well.

Durkheimian Approach:-

Emile Durkheim.

Classic Empiricist. Studied ↑ rate of suicides in post-capitalist Europe,

Does not treat it as a personal problem.

Humans are like puppets controlled by society as the puppet master, but humans can express animosity & volitionality and cut the threads connecting them to the puppet master.

Durkheim did not deal with the individuals rather, he tried to see how society moulds/modifies humans. Society was his primary unit of analysis.

Interested in seeing in what holds society together. This leads you towards Structural Functionalism.

Durkheim strove for objectivity, and believed numbers & data are objective. Focus on data → scientific study.

Individual value is only how much role they play in their social strata / social group et al.

Bias Handling? Social fact! way of acting, capable of exerting over the individual an external constraint. For ex: Disease Rate, pop. distribution etc. Constraint ≠ value judgement. Just a synonym of "influence".

Social facts can be social processes or social structures.

It is coercive. The coercion is also punitive.

Influences people

Pre-modern social solidarity = mechanical solidarity → simple unstructured homogeneous class / society + collective consensus within each segment.

Divine Providence & Divine Messengers share what God has ordained results in moral unity & consensus, glue holding pre-modern societies together.

Modern Societies have no consensus, breakdown in homogeneity. No consensus within clusters. Organic Solidarity. Breakdown due to industrialisation → increases individualism, division of labour. Lack of sense of shared society, understanding of interdependence used to be the case in the old moral order. Interdependence exists in the modern society too, but the interdependence is very transactional, unlike pre-modern societies. Results in a new moral order. This results in a form of Organic Solidarity. But there were a lot of abnormalities in the transition, and Organic solidarity cannot cover all the fields covered by Mechanical solidarity. Anomie ← rootlessness, lack of regulation, lack of moral discipline. Alienation in Marx's terms. Durkheim says that Anomie is a result of the transition. Need to build a moral code/order based on occupational associations → provides sense of belonging/solidarity/mutual assistance. Global North wanted wants solidarity, Global South wants individualism.

Max Weberian Ideas

Max Weber

Deeply interested in the individual. As sociologist, one must focus on the action. Verstehen (?) ← looking at the action by placing yourself in the actor's shoes. Identify intentionality behind the action. Actions have meanings. Even the clothes one wears can carry worth/value/meaning/intentionality.

Instead of having a uniform frame of reference, we must change our perspective to properly analyse individual actions.

Believes objectivity is not possible, embraces subjectivity.

Borrows from the cultural sciences rather than the natural sciences.

Study of social actions must not be empirical.

Rejects mono causality. No objective truth.

Motives

Social Action - Ideal Types:

- 1) Instrumentally rational:- $\exists$ a goal. Deeply instrumental/rational approach to achieve the goal. Anticipates / Expects behaviour of others. Enduring feature of modern society. No care about other wants, other considerations are side-lined.
- 2) Value rational:- Belief in values, and you follow that regardless of what the side-effects would be. Modern Society has this in $\downarrow$ quantities.
- 3) Emotional:- Deeply emotional, with no regard to consequences.
- 4) Traditional:- Ingrained habits.

Humans are a combination of the four.

Weber believes Emotional & Traditional are not rational.

These are patterns in behaviour. Modern society is moving towards more instrumental rational behaviour at both individual & societal spheres.

Bureaucracy exemplify instrumental rationality $\rightarrow$ societal level.
So ^{do} are Mechanisation & Division of labour.

Bureaucracy promises stability and a ability achieve your goals.
But Weber was not a fan of bureaucracy either, $\exists$ no heart in it, but it functions, hence they survive.

Ability to influence — power / party

Dominant caste is a Weberian class